

Anna Lieb

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Education

Wellesley College, Wellesley, MA

B.A. in Data Science (Computer Science concentration) & B.A. in Political Science, May 2024

3.95 GPA, summa cum laude with honors in data science

Honors thesis advised by Eni Mustafaraj (Computer Science) and Maneesh Arora (Political Science)

The “Perfect Villain:” A Computational Analysis of Critical Race Theory Controversies and Political Issue Framing in U.S. News. <https://repository.wellesley.edu/node/49380>

Work Experience

Pew Research Center, Washington, DC

Computational Social Science Research Analyst, July 2026 – present

Computational Social Science Research Assistant, September 2024 – July 2026

As a member of the Data Labs team, I conduct public-facing data science research on social media, online information, geographic analysis, and digital behaviors.

10a Labs, Washington, DC (remote)

Machine Learning Fellow, June – August 2024

Built and deployed a semantic search engine tool with Google Cloud Platform to help analysts explore trends in large-scale text datasets. Prepared reports and presented results to tech industry clients. Trained a classifier to identify potentially harmful online content; applied unsupervised ML to surface patterns in text.

Computational Analysis for Political Science Lab, Wellesley College, Wellesley, MA

Undergraduate Researcher, April 2023 – May 2024

Studied political issue framing in online news coverage of critical race theory controversy across the U.S. to complete senior honors thesis work co-advised in Computer Science and Political Science. Collected millions of online news articles and analyzed headline text data using time series regression models and NLP techniques including LLM prompt engineering and an augmented topic modeling technique to perform tasks including attribution, frame detection, and stance detection in news articles.

Global Diversity Lab, Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, MA

Undergraduate Research Assistant (UROP), September 2023 – December 2023

Assessed the availability of city-level data on climate challenges and local policy responses in Africa. Compiled data from local governments, news articles, scholarly literature, and public datasets to investigate African cities’ resilience to climate change. Analyzed text data to identify key indicators for climate pressures and responses.

Human-Centered Ubiquitous Media Lab, Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität München, Munich, Germany

Summer Research Assistant (NSF IRES), June 2023 – August 2023

Developed and evaluated a GPT-3.5-based physics education chatbot that uses prompt engineering and internal system messages to offer an automated personal tutoring experience for students. Designed two studies: 1) An observational study to assess modes of student interaction with our AI tutor chatbot, and 2) An online survey to study the effects of AI literacy on students’ learning gains in ChatGPT-facilitated tasks.

Human-Computer Interaction Institute, Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA
Summer Research Assistant (NSF REU), June – August 2022

Researched open-source software development community dynamics and developer collaboration on GitHub. Gathered, cleaned, and analyzed data from GitHub to create metrics for maintainers of open-source software projects to promote more diverse and inclusive contributor communities. Developed a metrics dashboard and conducted user testing interviews with open-source software developers to assess the impacts of the dashboard on community dynamics and maintainer behaviors over time.

Peer-Reviewed Publications

† denotes non-archival conference proceedings

† Samuel Bestvater, Athena Chapekis, Skyler Seets, **Anna Lieb**, Sono Shah, and Aaron Smith. (July 2026). “The Religious Radio Corpus: Building a Large-Scale Dataset of American Faith Broadcasting.” *12th International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2 2026)*, Burlington, VT. Extended dataset paper available at <https://arxiv.org/abs/2607.26249>

† Athena Chapekis, **Anna Lieb**, Sono Shah, & Aaron Smith. (July 2026). “Investigating Click Behaviors On Google Search Result Pages That Produce an AI Overview.” *12th International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2 2026)*, Burlington, VT.

† **Anna Lieb**, Athena Chapekis, Sono Shah, & Aaron Smith. (July 2026). “How Do Parents Use Online Communities? An Analysis of the r/Parenting Subreddit.” *12th International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2 2026)*, Burlington, VT.

Anna Lieb, Athena Chapekis, Sono Shah, & Aaron Smith. (2026). “How Do Parents Use Online Communities? An Analysis of the r/Parenting Subreddit.” In *Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM '26)*, 20(1), 3002–3008. <https://doi.org/10.1609/icwsml.v20i1.42799>

† **Anna Lieb**, Maneesh Arora, & Eni Mustafaraj. July 2024. “Creating Targeted, Interpretable Topic Models with LLM-Generated Text Augmentation.” (July 2024). *10th International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2 2024)*, Philadelphia, PA. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2504.17445>

Anna Lieb, Maneesh Arora, & Eni Mustafaraj. May 2024. “Online News Coverage of Critical Race Theory Controversies: A Dataset of Annotated Headlines.” In *Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM '24)*, 18(1), 1979–1990. <https://doi.org/10.1609/icwsml.v18i1.31441>

Anna Lieb & Toshali Goel. May 2024. “Student Interaction with NewtBot: An LLM-as-tutor Chatbot for Secondary Physics Education.” In *Extended Abstracts of the 2024 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '24)*. Association for Computing Machinery, Article 614, 1–8. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3613905.3647957>

Huilian Sophie Qiu, **Anna Lieb**, Jennifer Chou, Megan Carneal, Jasmine Mok, Emily Amspoker, Bogdan Vasilescu, & Laura Dabbish. April 2023. “Climate Coach: A Dashboard for Open-Source Maintainers to Overview Community Dynamics.” In *Proceedings of the 2023 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '23)*. Association for Computing Machinery, Article 552, 1–18. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3544548.3581317>

Selected Public Writing

Full Pew Research Center publication list at <https://www.pewresearch.org/staff/anna-lieb/>

Anna Lieb & Aaron Smith. June 2026. “Federal agency X accounts are getting far more engagement in the second Trump term than under Biden.” Pew Research Center (short read).

Galen Stocking, Regina Widjaya, **Anna Lieb**, Kaitlyn Radde, Aaron Smith & Eileen Yam. May 2026. “Moms, Coaches, Doctors, Entrepreneurs: Who Are America’s Health and Wellness Influencers?” Pew Research Center (report).

Anna Lieb, Athena Chapekis, Sono Shah, & Aaron Smith. Nov. 2025. “How Parents Use Online Communities.” Pew Research Center (report).

Athena Chapekis & **Anna Lieb**. July 2025. “Google users are less likely to click on links when an AI summary appears in the results.” Pew Research Center (short read).

Other Presentations

“Data for Social Impact Panel.” March 2026. With Jay Barchas-Lichtenstein & Kathy Zhang. Invited talk for Student Interdisciplinary Data Initiative, Wellesley College, Wellesley, MA

“Public Opinion Research & Computational Methods at Pew Research Center.” Feb. 2026. Invited talk for CS 298 / POL1 259: Social Media and Politics, Wellesley College, Wellesley, MA

“Roundtable on Artificial Intelligence and the Liberal Arts.” Nov. 2023. With Brian Brubach, Carolyn Anderson, Nicholas Gutierrez, Michelle Lee, Jyontika Kapoor, & Elizabeth Chen. Tanner Conference for Undergraduate Experiences at Wellesley College, Wellesley, MA.

“US-German Collaboration on AI for the Future of Education.” Jun. 2023. Student Consortium Presentation at CHIWORK Annual Meeting on Human-Computer Interaction for Work, Oldenburg, Germany.

“Diversity & Inclusion in Open-Source Software Communities.” Nov. 2022. Tanner Conference for Undergraduate Experiences at Wellesley College, Wellesley, MA.

Extracurricular & Professional Service

- **Reviewing:** IC2S2 2024, ICWSM 2026, IC2S2 2026
 - **ICWSM 2026 Best Reviewer Award** | Recognizes 20 reviewers whose reviews are of “especially good quality and usefulness”
- **Assistant Instructor**, Kode With Klossy, 2020, 2021, 2025 | Taught computer science courses for girls and students with underrepresented gender identities, with a focus on community, diversity, and inclusion in tech.
- **President of Fusion**, 2022-2024 | Wellesley College’s multiracial student organization
- **Peer Writing Tutor**, Wellesley College Writing Program, 2021 - 2024
- **Web Designer (Volunteer)**, Develop for Good, 2021 | Conducted UX research and web design for nonprofit clients

Honors and Awards

Sigma Xi, 2024 | Research honor society

CHI Student Research Competition Winner, 2024 | Third place undergraduate

Jerome A. Schiff Fellowship, 2023 | Awards excellence in independent undergraduate research with funding to support senior Honors thesis work at Wellesley College.

Albright Fellow, 2023 | Fellowship supported by the Madeleine K. Albright Institute for Global Affairs to prepare students to navigate a complex world with empathy, intellectual rigor, and purpose. Funds an international internship and a three-week intensive training designed to bridge the gap between academic theory and global practice.

Kode With Klossy Scholar, 2019 | Fully funded summer coding experience for young women and gender-expansive youth.

Selected Media Coverage

Drew Pittock / USA Today. Jun 4, 2026. "Transparency or confusion: Trump admin's X engagement outpaces Biden's"

<https://www.usatoday.com/story/news/politics/2026/06/04/trump-biden-pew-center-x-survey-engagement/90406909007/>

Teddy Rosenbluth / New York Times. May 7, 2026. "More People Are Getting Health Advice From TikTok and Instagram. Is That a Good Thing?"

https://www.nytimes.com/2026/05/07/well/health-wellness-influencers-pew.html?unlocked_article_code=1.2FA.CxDJ.h0tKYW0ViERb&smid=url-share

Dylan Scott / Vox. May 7, 2026. "Do health influencers actually know what they're talking about?"

<https://www.vox.com/good-medicine-newsletter/487970/health-and-wellness-social-media-influencers-pew-report>

Andrea Petersen / Wall Street Journal. May 7, 2026. "Who Exactly Is That Wellness Influencer? Not Likely a Doctor or Nurse."

<https://www.wsj.com/health/wellness/who-exactly-is-that-wellness-influencer-not-likely-a-doctor-or-nurse-13fe0a4b>

Barbara Rodriguez / The 19th. May 7, 2026. "Women lead as health and wellness influencers. Why do so many men have more followers?" <https://19thnews.org/2026/05/women-health-wellness-influencers/>

Heather Kelly / Washington Post. Nov 17, 2025. "Screen-time worries send parents in increasingly desperate directions." <https://wapo.st/43AWWB8>

Bethany Braun-Silva / ABC News & Good Morning America. Nov 16, 2025. "Parents turning to online communities for advice." <https://youtu.be/KRj-JFDeIf0?si=bpQig5ubBsGxyiad>

Penske Media Corp. et al. v. Google LLC (antitrust lawsuit). Sept 12, 2025.

<https://www.courtlistener.com/docket/71332589/1/penske-media-corporation-v-google-llc/>

Emma Roth / The Verge. Aug. 6, 2025. "Google swears it isn't destroying the web with AI search."
<https://www.theverge.com/news/720069/google-ai-overviews-search-web-traffic-stable>

Thomas Germain / BBC. Jul 29, 2025. "You might be ghosting the internet. Can it survive?"
<https://www.bbc.com/future/article/20250728-you-might-be-ghosting-the-internet-can-it-survive>

Jackie Snow / Quartz. Jul 28, 2025. "The old internet is dying. What's next?"
<https://qz.com/internet-future-google-search-ai>

Emanuel Maiberg / 404 Media. Jul 23, 2025. "Google's AI Is Destroying Search, the Internet, and Your Brain."
<https://www.404media.co/googles-ai-is-destroying-search-the-internet-and-your-brain/>

Casey Newton / Platformer. Jul 22, 2025. "The Google study that told us what we already suspected."
<https://www.platformer.news/google-ai-overviews-pew-research/?ref=platformer-newsletter>